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Sibling Rivalry

Author:

K.R. Schneider

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[Two brothers, Tim *and* Tom*, have not seen each other in ten years. After their father dies, they have to come home for the reading of his will.]*

(*Both brothers are getting ready to leave their respective homes; they stand facing opposite directions, each packing toiletries in a bathroom.)*

TIM: Honey, have you seen my black shirt? *(pauses to listen)* Can't I go without a tie? I hate wearing a tie!
TOM: Laura, did you call the financial advisor? *(pauses to listen)* And you packed my good cufflinks?
BOTH: I heard you; I'm almost ready!
TIM: I have to see my stuck up, jerk brother.
TOM: I have to see my underachieving, clown of a brother.
(Both turn to "look in the mirror" but are facing each other, treating the other as their own reflection.)
BOTH: I guess it's what dad would have wanted.

(TIM and TOM sit in chairs facing opposite directions, driving their respective cars home for the funeral - each on the phone with their mother. They freeze when the other has a line.)

TIM: Hey, Mom. I'm about twenty minutes out. Tommy there yet?
TOM: Hi, Mom. No, I'll be early. Timmy there yet?
TIM: Of course he is. He get your taxes done already too?
TOM: Yeah. That about figures. I'm sure he'll come rolling in late.
TIM: I'm sorry. He just has to one-up me all the time!
TOM: I'm sorry. It's just typical Timmy. Never on time.
TIM: I'll be as nice as he deserves, how about that?
TOM: I'll do my best to keep the peace, but if I hear one joke about a busload of preachers in the apocalypse…
TIM: I'm just saying, we've never been *close*, Mom. If he doesn't talk down to me, I won't punch him.
TOM: He *did* tell that joke! At *Grandpa's* funeral!
TIM: Okay, okay. I promise I'll try.
TOM: I know. I'll do my best.
TIM & TOM: See you soon, Mom. Love you too.

(TIM is entering the kitchen backwards, yelling back to the car at his wife; TOM is seated at the kitchen table.)

TIM: Honey, just leave the bags; we'll get 'em later! Don't carry that one. That's the heavy one!
TOM: Still leaving the heavy lifting for your lady, I see.
TIM: *(turns and takes in the way that Tom is sitting - with his legs crossed)* Still sitting like a teenage cheerleader, I see.
TOM: *(uncrosses his legs)* Mature, Timothy.
TIM: *(mocking him)* Haughty, Thomas.
TOM: *(leans in to shake his hand awkwardly)* So. How are you? Are you well?
TIM: Am I *well*? We haven't spoken in ten years, and that's your opener?
TOM: What would you prefer? Punches thrown?
TIM: Might be a little more sincere. But since you asked, no. My dad's dead, Tommy. So no, I'm not *well.*
TOM: Hey, he was my dad too!
TIM: And clearly you're doing *well* with things.
TOM: He was *my* dad too.
TIM: He was my dad first, skunk-hole.
TOM: Wow. Well, you're still charming as ever, Tim.
TIM: You're still a prissy little girl, Tom.
TOM: I tried to be civil. I guess maybe that was too much to ask for from someone like you.
TIM: I'm sorry, someone like me?
TOM: You're a loser, Timmy; you've always been a loudmouthed loser.
TIM: Oh, really? As I recall there were a few occasions when you *needed* this loudmouthed loser to pull your duct taped little nerd butt off of your locker.
TOM: One. One occasion! And it wasn't my *locker*, it was the oak tree on the quad!
TIM: Well catch my carp, Tommy, that's *much* more respectable.

[FLASHBACK: TOM, as a cruel prank, has been duct taped to a tree in the school's outdoor area. TIM has come outside to sneak a cigarette.]

TOM: Tim, hey! Tim? Hey, over here!
TIM: Hi Tommy…*(taking in the scene)* how's lunch?
TOM: *(sarcastic)* Fantastic.
TIM: Mmhhm. *(pulls out a pack of cigarettes from his pocket)* Ya look a little...tied up.
TOM: Yeah, nothing gets by you, Timmy.
TIM: You uh...protesting the cafeteria food or something? *(lights a cigarette)*
TOM: Can you just cut me down, please? Wait, are you smoking?
TIM: Well, yeah. I didn't come out here to rope myself to the rose bushes.
TOM: That's disgusting, you know. Nobody wants to kiss a smoker.

TIM: Wasn't really planning on kissing you, Tom.
TOM: Shove it, okay? Obviously I meant girls. Girls don't want to kiss a smoker.
TIM: Yeah, how's not smoking helping *your* game? You get an extra kiss from Grandma?
TOM: For your information, I do just fine thank-
TIM: Yeah. I'm sure you do, Tommy. Well this has been fun, but Biology waits for no man, so...
TOM: Wait! You have to cut me down.
TIM: Do I? Do I *really*? I mean you give me hell about my habits, even though it's lucky for you really that I came out here, and then you talk down to me, and *now* you want my help?
TOM: Yes.
TIM: Yes what?
TOM: Yes, please? Come on, Tim!
TIM: I actually prefer that you call me Master and Commander.
TOM: You've got to be kidding me.
TIM: "You've got to be kidding me, Master and Commander."
TOM: Just cut me down, you idiot! (*Tim moves to walk away)* Okay, okay. Cut me down, *(mumbles "master and commander")*
TIM: I'm sorry, Tommy, I just couldn't quite make that out.
TOM: I said cut me down, Master and Commander.
TIM: Oh gosh, man you flatter me. Happy to!

[PRESENT: TIM & TOM are sitting in the kitchen of their parents' house.]

TOM: You were a jerk.
TIM: I'm sorry, I think you mean, "You were a jerk, Master and Commander."
TOM: Shove it, Timmy.
(TIM shoves the side of TOM's head - TOM pushes TIM back - they start a shoving match)
TIM: Hey, what the hell, man?
TOM: You shoved me!
TIM: You told me to!
TOM: Tim, obviously I didn't mean for you to shove me!
TIM: You said shove it. I shoved it.
TOM: This is sophomore homecoming all over again.
TIM: What does that mean?
TOM: You went home with my date!
TIM: You told me to!
TOM: Tim!

[FLASHBACK: The homecoming dance. TOM is sitting at a table with his date, NANCY - Tim imitates Nancy.]

NANCY: Your brother is a senior right?
TOM: He's a junior.
NANCY: Do you guys like, hang out all the time?
TOM: Me and Tim?
NANCY: Yeah does he like, drive you places and take you to parties and stuff?
TOM: Tim? Nancy, have you met Tim?
NANCY: He seems like he'd be *such* a gentleman, you know? Tom, you're so lucky to have a brother like Tim.
TOM: Last week he tried to chloroform me with a dirty gym sock.
NANCY: That's funny! Oh my gosh, Tim is *so* funny, right?
TOM: I'm not sure that's the adjective I'd employ.
NANCY: Huh?
TOM: Nothing, nevermind. Hey, don't you have to take pictures for the yearbook tonight?
NANCY: Oh, right! I'll be right back. If Tim comes over, tell him I said hi.
TOM: Sure.

[The boys switch places. Tim goes back to being himself]

TIM: Hey, man. Rad dance right?
TOM: I don't know; I haven't danced.
TIM: Why not? I saw you walk in with Nancy Jergens; she's hot.
TOM: Yeah, actually I feel more like I'm here with you.
TIM: No, Tommy. I'm here stag. Stag is cool, you know? Playing the field.
TOM: Yeah, I know. Nancy said it's "sooo cool to come without a date; like how brave is that?"
TIM: You came *with* a date.
TOM: I know.
TIM: Your date is Nancy.
TOM: Yeah, Tim. I know that. Honestly, she's spent enough time talking about you tonight that we might as well switch places.
TIM: What, like me go home with Nancy and you go solo?
TOM: Yeah, honestly it might be better than having her as my date.
TIM: *(slaps Tom on the shoulder)* Happy to take one for the team, man.

[PRESENT: Their parents' kitchen.]

TIM: You *asked* me to take her home!
TOM: I was bonding with my brother! I thought you were just trying to show moral support!
TIM: No, Thomas, obviously I wanted to make out with your date!
TOM: Obviously.

TIM: If it makes you feel any better, I cut my lip on her braces.
TOM: No, wildly Timmy, that actually does not make me feel any better.
TIM: Oh. Cause I kissed her?
TOM: Yup.
TIM: I mean it was like a million years ago.
TOM: It's the principle of the thing, Tim!
BOTH: *(to Mom offstage)* We're not fighting!
TIM: We're fine, Mom!
TOM: We're great.
TIM: Come on, Tom, it's not like all of our memories are bad, right? I've done nice things for you.
TOM: You mean like the time you locked me out of the house in my underwear in January, and I caught pneumonia?
TIM: Okay, that's a bad example. But I sold *all* of your boy scout popcorn that year!
TOM: Because I was bed-ridden!
TIM: I still did it. I sold so much popcorn, you won that ten-speed you wanted.
TOM: Yeah. That *was* a great bike.
TIM: Neon green with the black stripe. It was a sick bike, man.
TOM: You made me ramp it off the playground slide.
TIM: You got some air on that ramp!
TOM: I broke my wrist. And I sliced my chin open. *(points to his chin)* I still have the scar!
TIM: Yeah, and I rode you to the hospital on my handlebars!
TOM: *(starting to lighten up)* Yeah. Yeah, I guess you did.
TIM: I wasn't the worst brother all the time.
TOM: You put a snake in my bed.
TIM: I didn't say I was perfect, Tom. And you put a mouse trap in my slippers; that was way worse!
TOM: You woke Dad up after a night shift, and I was grounded for like two weeks.
TIM: You put a *mouse trap* in my *slippers*!
TOM: Okay, yeah. I'll take that one. That was my fault.
TIM: See, I'm not always the bad guy. Remember the time you pushed me in the lake?
TOM: I'm pretty sure you hooked me in the head with your fishing pole first.
TIM: Details…

[FLASHBACK: The boys are pre-teens, at the lake together. TIM is teaching TOM how to cast a fishing pole.]

TOM: Okay, so I just hold this down, and then...fling it?
TIM: No, here, like this.
(Tim demonstrates a proper cast.)

TOM: Okay, cool. I got this now.
TIM: Yeah, you're a real man now, Tommy. Can cast a fishing pole and everything.
TOM: Thanks. For showing me, I mean. Thanks.
TIM: Okay, I'll be down the bank a bit; holler if you need me.
(Tim walks a few paces away, his back is to Tom, to cast his pole. He throws his line back too far and snags Tom's head on the upswing.)
TOM: *(screaming in pain)* HEY! *(Tim pulls the pole)* HEY!
TIM: Hold on; I'm snagged on something here. *(pulls harder)*
TOM: Timmy stop it! My head!
TIM: Stop wailing Tommy, I'll help you in a second; I'm *snagged* here.
TOM: YOU ARE SNAGGED IN MY FLESH!
TIM: *(turns, realizes what has happened)* Geez, Tommy! Why didn't you say somethin'??
(Tim rushes over to help.)
TOM: You have GOT to be kidding me! I was screaming! You HEARD me.
TIM: Well, I heard you wailin'; I just thought you had a fish or something.
TOM: *(gets the hook out of his scalp)* ARE *(shoves him)* YOU *(shoves him)* KIDDING ME?
TIM: Hey, what the hell, man! Quit shoving me.
TOM: You caught my scalp on a lure!
TIM: *(shoves back)* Not on purpose!
TOM: You yanked it in!
TIM: Well that's what you do when you're snagged, Thomas!
(Tom shoves Tim into the lake.)

[PRESENT: Back at their parents' house.]

TIM: It was not necessary to shove me into the lake.
TOM: Tim, if I had a dollar for all of the scars you've caused me.
TIM: All you ever are is mad at me; I don't even know why I try!
TOM: Because you're a pain in my neck at every turn!
TIM: What about the time I won on that scratch ticket? And I split the money with you!
TOM: You *owed* me that money after I bailed you out of *jail*!
TIM: Oh. Right. Well, I got you out of your relationship with Molly. She was awful.
TOM: You're not seriously calling that a favor.
TIM: Yeah, man. She was terrible. I totally got you out of that.
TOM: You *hooked up with her*.
TIM: For YOU.
TOM: Gee, thanks, Tim.
TIM: Yes. You're welcome. Finally, some appreciation.
TOM: You can't be serious.
TIM: What?

TOM: Just forget it. Look, neither of us are perfect, okay? Let's just forget it, and get through the next couple of days.
TIM: Fine. We'll try to get along. You know, I actually brought you something.
TOM: Yeah? That's funny; I have something I need to give you too.
(Each of them pulls out a box to give to the other - they open them at the same time.)
TIM: A watch?
TOM: A knife?
BOTH: Dad gave it to me.
(They look at each other in surprise.)
TOM: He gave me that watch when I turned eighteen.
TIM: When I…became a man...
BOTH: And I wanted you to have it because…
(again, look at each other strangely)
TOM: Dad said it was
TIM: ...his most prized possession.
TOM: Yeah. And obviously it was really the watch because...I mean - well, I was Dad's favorite.
TIM: Uh, no. I was definitely Dad's favorite.
TOM: You're delusional!
TIM: You're an idiot!
TOM: Great comeback!
TIM: Great sweater vest!
(They start to physically scuffle.)
TOM: Shut-up.
TIM: You shut-up.
TOM: Make me.
TIM: Oh, gladly.
(pause their scuffle when Mom calls in from the other room - TIM has TOM in a headlock)
TOM: No, mom! We're fine.
TIM: We're good!
BOTH: We're not fighting!